

BUSINESS ANALYST CASE STUDY

NeighbourNet

*Designing a Trusted, Unified Digital Ecosystem for
Hyperlocal Resource Sharing & Trusted Local Services*

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Independent Business Analysis Portfolio Project • Illustrative Business Case • Not Affiliated With Any Live Commercial Entity

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1. Executive Summary

Across most residential neighbourhoods, two everyday problems persist side by side: households buy items they use only rarely, while neighbours who already own the same items have no safe way to lend them; and finding a verified electrician, tutor, or photographer still depends on WhatsApp groups and word-of-mouth. NeighbourNet is proposed as a single, verified digital ecosystem that solves both problems together, rather than the fragmented, single-purpose way today's marketplace and services apps solve them separately.

This case study is built the way a real consulting engagement is structured — from a validated business problem, through market research and root-cause analysis, into a recommended solution, requirement prioritisation, a phased roadmap, and measurable success criteria.

Key Findings at a Glance

Dimension	Finding
Core Problem	No existing platform combines verified neighbourhood trust, item-sharing, and local service booking in one place.
Market Gap	5 benchmarked platforms each solve only one slice of the problem — trust, sharing, or services — never all three.
Root Cause	Absence of identity verification and a unified digital process, not lack of user willingness to share.
Recommended Fix	A single verified platform integrating marketplace, bookings, chat, payments, and community trust scoring.
Projected Impact	8,000 projected monthly active users and 5,400 completed transactions by end of Year 1 post-pilot.

What This Case Study Demonstrates

- Structured problem framing and stakeholder analysis
- Competitive benchmarking and market gap research
- Root-cause analysis using Ishikawa (Fishbone) and 5 Whys
- AS-IS → TO-BE process redesign and MoSCoW requirement prioritisation
- Business impact quantification, KPI design, phased roadmap, and risk mitigation

2. Business Context & Problem Statement

About NeighbourNet

NeighbourNet is a proposed hyperlocal community platform connecting verified residents within the same neighbourhood or apartment community — to borrow, rent, sell, exchange, and donate household items, and to discover and book trusted local service providers such as tutors, electricians, plumbers, and photographers, all inside one verified, community-first application.

Three pillars: verified trust (identity checks, ratings, reviews) · resource efficiency (sharing under-used items) · local economic opportunity (helping nearby freelancers reach genuine demand).

Industry Context

India's sharing economy and hyperlocal services market has grown rapidly, led by services marketplaces (Urban Company) and classifieds platforms (OLX, Facebook Marketplace). Dense apartment communities in Tier 1/2 cities create natural, trust-adjacent neighbourhood units — residents already share a gate, a lift, and a WhatsApp group, but not a structured platform to transact safely. NeighbourNet sits at the intersection of three established trends — resale/rental, local services, and hyperlocal community coordination — combined for the first time into one verified product.

Problem Statement

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Neighbourhoods lack a single trusted platform to share under-used household resources and hire verified local service providers — forcing residents onto fragmented, low-trust channels that waste money, time, and community goodwill.

Who Is Affected

Affected Group	Impact of the Problem
Households / Residents	Spend on items used only occasionally; struggle to find verified help nearby.
Local Freelancers & Providers	Limited visibility to nearby customers; depend on inconsistent referrals.
Apartment Associations	No structured tool to manage shared resources, trust, or engagement.
Environment / Community	Under-utilised resources and unnecessary purchases increase waste.

Why now: Informal WhatsApp groups already show residents actively trying to lend, borrow, and refer services — demand isn't the gap. The gap is structural: no platform provides identity verification, a standard process, secure payment, and dispute protection together, so users default to riskier informal exchange or simply buy new / pay more.

3. Target Users & Personas

Two representative personas illustrate the range of people NeighbourNet serves — one primarily sharing/borrowing items, the other offering a local service. Designing for both on one platform is central to the product's value proposition.

Attribute	Persona 1 — Priya, The Practical Resident	Persona 2 — Arun, The Local Freelancer
Profile	28, working professional, mid-sized apartment community	24, freelance photographer building a local client base
Goal	Host a birthday party without buying decorations she'll use once	Consistent, nearby bookings without high commissions to large apps
Pain Point	Doesn't know which neighbours own decorations; hesitant to ask strangers on WhatsApp	Relies on inconsistent word-of-mouth; struggles to build a visible profile nearby
How NeighbourNet Helps	Searches verified listings, books & pays in-app, returns item with a review	Verified profile with booking calendar, discovered by nearby residents, builds public rating

Both personas share the same underlying need: a trusted, structured way to connect with people who already live nearby. Treating item-sharing and service-booking as one need rather than two separate products is the core product insight behind NeighbourNet.

4. Research Methodology & Market Analysis

Research combined secondary research on five widely-used platforms with a structured feature audit. Each platform was scored 1 (weak) to 5 (strong) across five capability dimensions: verified trust, item sharing, local service booking, community engagement, and unified experience.

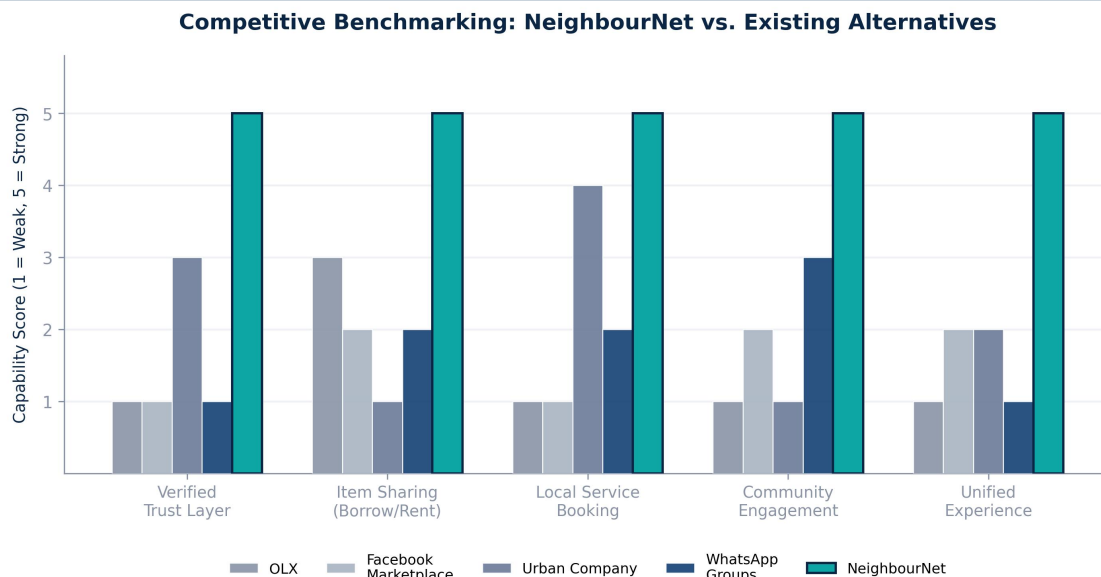


Figure 1 — Capability comparison across five existing alternatives and NeighbourNet.

The benchmarking makes the gap explicit: Urban Company scores well on service booking but not item-sharing; OLX and Facebook Marketplace support selling but lack verification and services; WhatsApp groups enable engagement but offer no structure, payments, or safety. No competitor combines all five capabilities.

Market Gap Analysis

Platform	Strength	Key Gap
OLX	Large resale marketplace reach	No verification; no rental/borrowing workflow; no services
Facebook Marketplace	Wide, free-to-use audience	Weak trust signals; no local service booking; not hyperlocal
Urban Company	Strong verified service booking	No item-sharing; not community-owned or neighbourhood-based
WhatsApp Groups	High engagement, zero cost	No structure, payments, verification, or dispute handling
Gain (community apps)	Some community focus	Limited depth; inconsistent verification and monetisation

KEY INSIGHT

The market does not lack sharing-economy demand — it lacks a platform that treats verified trust as a first-class feature rather than an afterthought.

5. Root-Cause Analysis

To avoid designing around symptoms, the causes of low neighbourhood resource-sharing were analysed with two complementary techniques: the Ishikawa (Fishbone) diagram to organise causes into categories, and the 5 Whys to drill into the deepest root cause.

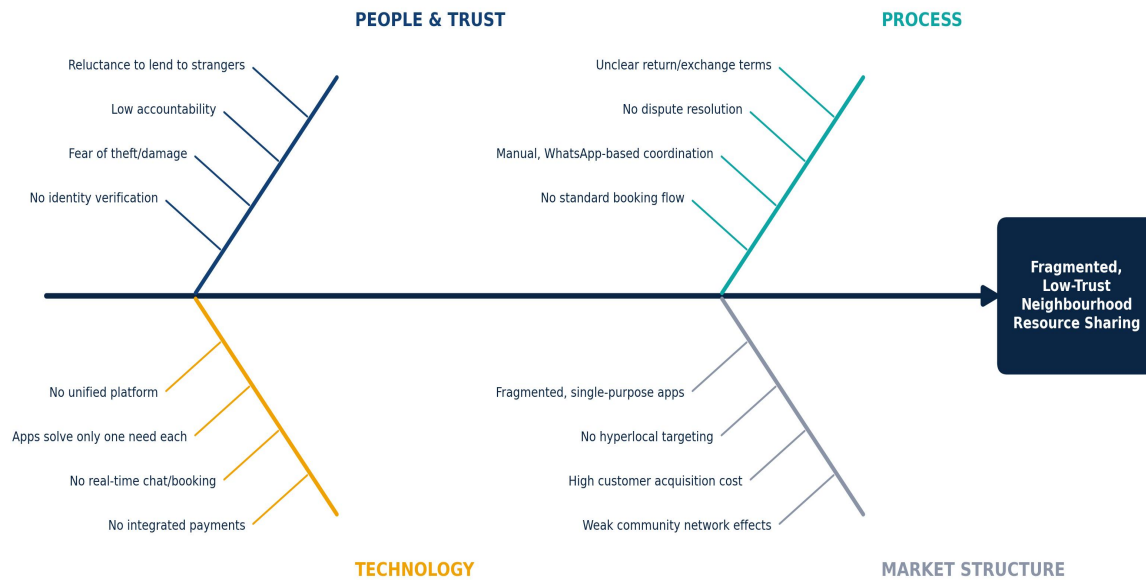


Figure 2 — Root causes grouped by People & Trust, Process, Technology, and Market Structure.

The 5 Whys

Step	Question & Answer
Why 1	Why do neighbours rarely lend/rent to each other? → They do not know or trust the other person enough.
Why 2	Why is there not enough trust? → There is no way to verify a neighbour's identity or reliability.
Why 3	Why is there no verification mechanism? → Current channels (WhatsApp, word of mouth) were never built for transactions.
Why 4	Why hasn't a dedicated platform been adopted? → Existing apps solve only selling, or only services — not both.
Why 5 — Root Cause	Why does no platform combine both? → No product has been designed specifically around verified, hyperlocal, multi-purpose community trust.

6. Stakeholder Analysis

Identifying stakeholders early ensures the solution addresses real needs across every group involved in adoption and success, not just end users.

Stakeholder	Interest	Influence	Engagement Strategy
Residents (Borrowers/Lenders)	High	High	User research, beta testing, feedback loops, in-app incentives
Freelancers / Service Providers	High	Medium	Free early listings, onboarding support, visibility guarantees
Apartment Associations	Medium	High	Pilot partnerships, bulk resident onboarding, admin dashboards
Platform Administrators	High	High	Moderation tools, fraud dashboards, escalation workflows
Payment Gateway Partners	Medium	Medium	API integration, compliance alignment, SLA agreements
Future Logistics Partners	Low (initially)	Low (initially)	Evaluated in later growth phases for delivery-assisted items

Residents and apartment associations carry the highest combined interest and influence — making early pilot partnerships with a small number of apartment communities the most effective adoption strategy.

7. Proposed Solution

NeighbourNet combines four capability layers into one product: a verified identity & trust layer; a marketplace layer (borrow, rent, sell, exchange, donate); a services layer (discover & book local professionals); and a community layer (chat, ratings, reviews, notifications). Every transaction flows through the same verified, secure process.

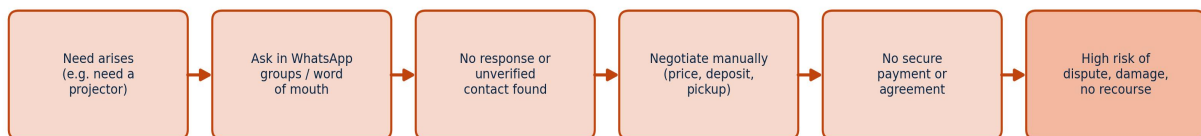
Feature-to-Problem Mapping

Business Problem	NeighbourNet Feature	Business Outcome
No identity verification	OTP + document-based verification at sign-up	Increases willingness to lend/borrow; reduces fraud
Fragmented discovery	Unified marketplace + services module with search & filters	One app instead of five; higher engagement & retention
No secure transaction process	In-app booking, chat, UPI payments with deposit protection	Reduces disputes; safe, repeatable transaction flow
No post-transaction accountability	Ratings, reviews, cumulative trust score per user	Long-term reputation incentives for good behaviour
Low visibility for freelancers	Searchable provider profiles with booking calendars	Expands local livelihood opportunities & repeat bookings
No community-level oversight	Apartment-association-linked admin dashboard	Enables moderation, dispute handling, bulk onboarding

8. Process Reengineering: AS-IS vs. TO-BE

Mapping the current (AS-IS) process against the proposed (TO-BE) process makes the redesign concrete: borrowing a projector moves from an unstructured, high-risk chain of manual steps to a short, verified, digitally-supported flow.

AS-IS: Fragmented Manual Process



TO-BE: NeighbourNet Unified Digital Process

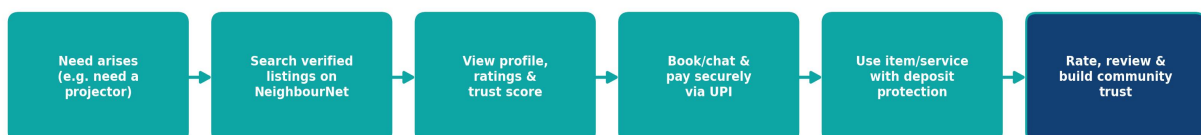


Figure 3 — AS-IS manual, WhatsApp-based process vs. the TO-BE unified NeighbourNet process.

The redesign removes three failure points: an unanswered/unverified WhatsApp message, the absence of secure payment, and the lack of recourse for damage or unsatisfactory service — replaced with verified listings, secure in-app payment, and deposit-backed protection with review-based accountability.

9. Requirements Snapshot

The full BRD captures detailed functional, non-functional, and business rule requirements. This snapshot uses MoSCoW prioritisation to show how scope was structured for a phased build.

Priority	Requirement
Must Have	OTP-based registration & login; identity verification; item/service listing creation; booking workflow; UPI payment integration; ratings & reviews
Should Have	In-app chat; wishlist; push notifications; admin moderation dashboard; security deposit handling
Could Have	AI-based recommendations; community trust score; gamified badges; sustainability impact dashboard
Won't Have (This Phase)	Third-party logistics/delivery integration; multi-city expansion tools; voice search

This ensures the MVP focuses entirely on establishing trust and completing a full transaction loop before layering on engagement and intelligence features.

10. Business Impact, Revenue & KPIs

Value is assessed across three lenses: direct household savings, local economic opportunity, and platform revenue. Figures below are illustrative estimates built to demonstrate business-value reasoning, not measured production data.

- Households avoid low-frequency purchases by borrowing/renting instead — estimated savings of ₹3,000–₹8,000/year for an actively participating family.
- Local freelancers gain a low-cost customer acquisition channel vs. relying on referrals or expensive third-party apps.
- Apartment associations gain a structured tool for engagement and dispute visibility, reducing informal WhatsApp friction.

Revenue Model

Revenue Stream	Description
Transaction Commission	Small % fee on completed bookings, rentals, and service payments
Premium Memberships	Optional paid tier: priority listing visibility, lower commission
Featured Listings	Paid promotion for items or providers within their local area
Business Subscriptions	Monthly plans for local businesses needing consistent visibility
Local Advertising	Hyperlocal ad placements for community-relevant businesses

KPIs & Success Metrics

KPI	Definition	Target (Year 1)
Monthly Active Users	Unique residents engaging per month	8,000
Completed Transactions	Successfully closed bookings, rentals, or sales	5,400 (cumulative)
Repeat User Rate	Share completing more than one transaction	≥ 40%
Average Rating	Mean rating across completed transactions	≥ 4.3 / 5
Booking Completion Rate	Bookings completed vs. initiated	≥ 85%
Dispute Rate	Transactions resulting in a formal dispute	< 3%

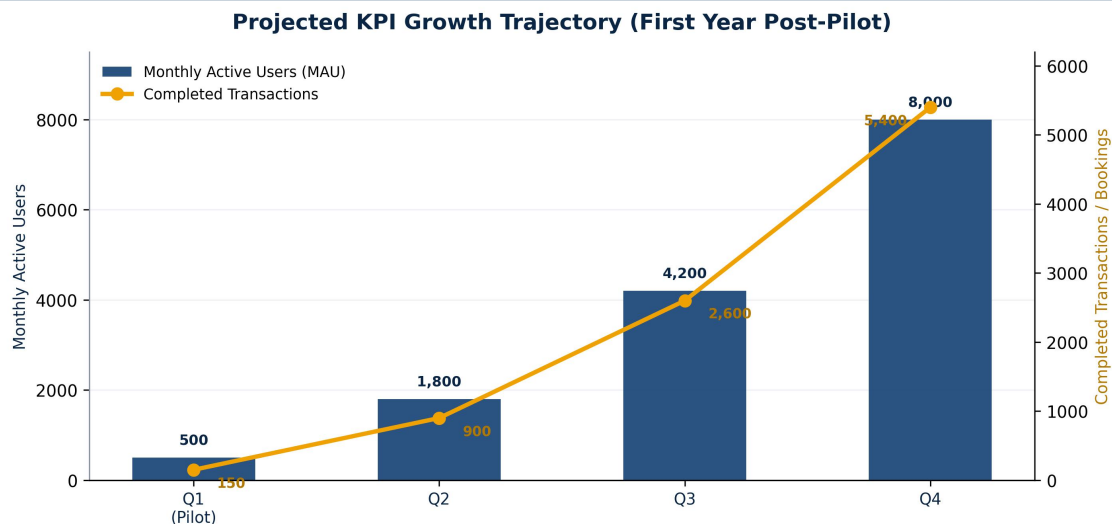


Figure 4 — Projected quarterly growth in MAU and completed transactions, Year 1 post-pilot.

BUSINESS VALUE STATEMENT

NeighbourNet converts an existing informal habit — neighbours already trying to share and refer informally — into a monetisable, trust-verified transaction layer, rather than creating new user behaviour from scratch.

11. Implementation Roadmap

A phased, 12-month roadmap sequences discovery, design, build, pilot, and scaled rollout — front-loading requirement and trust-mechanism validation before wider investment in growth.

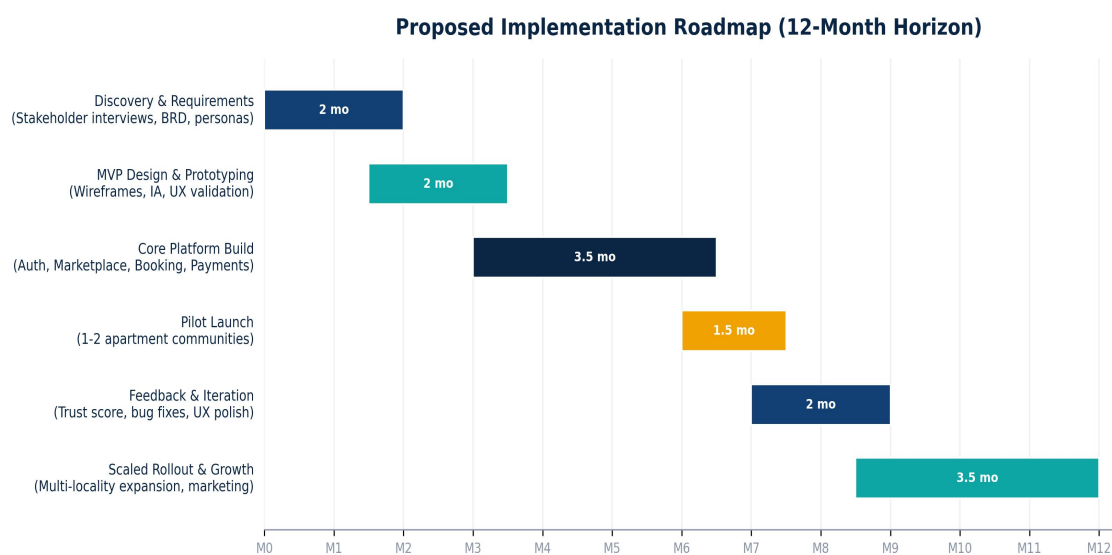


Figure 5 — Proposed 12-month implementation roadmap from discovery through scaled rollout.

Phase	Key Deliverables
1. Discovery & Requirements	Stakeholder interviews, BRD, personas, journey maps
2. MVP Design & Prototyping	Information architecture, low-fi wireframes, UX validation
3. Core Platform Build	Authentication, marketplace, booking engine, chat, UPI
4. Pilot Launch	Controlled rollout across 1–2 apartment communities with hands-on support
5. Feedback & Iteration	Trust-score refinement, bug fixes, UX polish based on pilot feedback
6. Scaled Rollout & Growth	Multi-locality expansion, marketing push, subscription onboarding

12. Risk Assessment & Mitigation Register

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation Strategy
Fake or duplicate user profiles	Medium	High	Mandatory OTP + ID verification; anomaly-detection flags
Item damage / non-return disputes	Medium	High	Refundable security deposits; return-condition photos at handover
Payment disputes / failed transactions	Low	High	Escrow-style hold on UPI payments until confirmation
Privacy concerns over location/profile data	Medium	Medium	Minimal data collection; visible privacy controls; encryption
Low initial user adoption	High	Medium	Apartment-association pilot partnerships; referral incentives
Service-provider quality inconsistency	Medium	Medium	Mandatory ratings/reviews; minimum-rating thresholds

Low initial adoption is treated as the highest-priority risk in Year 1, since trust-based platforms depend on reaching critical mass within each pilot community before referral-led growth takes over.

13. Recommendations & Future Scope

Beyond the MVP, the following are recommended once the core trust and transaction loop is validated in the pilot phase:

- **AI-based recommendations** — suggest relevant nearby items/services based on activity and neighbourhood trends.
- **Community trust score** — a cumulative, transparent score combining verification, ratings, and history.
- **Emergency assistance mode** — fast-path request type for urgent local help (e.g., a plumber for a leak).
- **Community events & volunteer network** — extend beyond transactions into neighbourhood coordination.
- **Skill exchange** — trade skills (e.g., tutoring for photography) without a monetary transaction.
- **Sustainability dashboard** — show each user's cumulative contribution to reduced purchases and waste.
- **Smart fraud detection** — pattern-based detection of suspicious listing or messaging behaviour.

14. Lessons Learned — BA Skills Demonstrated

Building this case study end-to-end reinforced how each BA technique connects to the next — a benchmarking gap justifies a root-cause investigation, which justifies a specific feature, which is then prioritised, resourced, and measured.

BA Competency	Demonstrated Through
Business Problem Framing	Structured problem statement with affected-stakeholder impact analysis
Market & Competitive Research	Five-platform benchmarking across weighted capability dimensions
Root-Cause Analysis	Ishikawa (Fishbone) diagram and the 5 Whys technique
Stakeholder Management	Interest/influence matrix with tailored engagement strategies
Process Modelling	AS-IS vs. TO-BE workflow redesign
Requirements Prioritisation	MoSCoW-based scope definition for MVP planning
Business Case Development	Quantified value analysis and multi-stream revenue model
Performance Measurement	KPI framework with quarterly growth projections
Delivery Planning	Phased 12-month implementation roadmap
Risk Management	Likelihood/impact risk register with mitigation ownership

15. Conclusion

NeighbourNet demonstrates that the biggest opportunity in the neighbourhood-sharing and local-services space is not a missing feature, but a missing layer of structured trust. Every technique applied here — benchmarking, root-cause analysis, stakeholder mapping, process redesign, prioritisation, and KPI planning — was used to validate that a single, verified, community-first platform can convert an already-existing informal behaviour into a safe, scalable, and monetisable product.

As a portfolio project, this case study demonstrates applied Business Analyst thinking: moving from an ambiguous, real-world problem to a structured, evidence-backed, prioritised solution — the same process a Business Analyst applies on an actual product initiative.

Appendix A — Tools & Techniques Applied

Tool / Technique	Purpose in This Case Study
Competitive Benchmarking Matrix	Compared NeighbourNet against 5 alternatives across 5 dimensions
Ishikawa (Fishbone) Diagram	Organised root causes into People & Trust, Process, Technology, Market
5 Whys	Traced the surface problem to its structural root cause
Stakeholder Interest/Influence Matrix	Prioritised engagement strategy across six stakeholder groups
AS-IS / TO-BE Process Mapping	Visualised the current manual process vs. the proposed digital workflow
MoSCoW Prioritisation	Structured MVP scope into Must/Should/Could/Won't Have
KPI Framework	Defined leading and lagging indicators for post-launch success
Gantt-Style Roadmap	Sequenced a 12-month, six-phase implementation plan
Risk Register (Likelihood × Impact)	Assessed and mitigated top operational and adoption risks

Appendix B — Glossary of Terms

Term	Meaning
BRD	Business Requirements Document — formal document capturing business needs
MoSCoW	Prioritisation technique: Must / Should / Could / Won't have (this time)
MAU	Monthly Active Users — a core engagement metric
MVP	Minimum Viable Product — smallest usable version delivering core value
Ishikawa / Fishbone	Root-cause tool organising causes into categories around a central effect
5 Whys	Root-cause technique repeatedly asking 'why' to move from symptom to cause
AS-IS / TO-BE	Process terms describing the current state and the proposed future state
KPI	Key Performance Indicator — measurable progress toward an objective
UPI	Unified Payments Interface — real-time payment system used in India
Trust Score	Cumulative reputation metric combining verification, ratings, history